Nika Sandler is a contemporary artist working with photography, artificial intelligence, and text. Her work has been described in international publications as addressing the relations between human and non-human gazes, gender, pleasure, and the aesthetics of the uncanny and the abject.

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Biography

edit

Sandler studied at the Docdocdoc School of Contemporary Photography, completing Feodora Kaplan's course *Experiments in Contemporary Photography*. Her work has been featured in numerous international publications, including *i-D*, *Dazed* (...), *Photologue* (...), *Harper's Bazaar*, *Libération*, *Unthinking Photography*, *Konbini* (...), *Fisheye Magazine* (...), *The Calvert Journal*, *Público*, *Metal Magazine* (...), *L'Oeil de la Photographie*, *Float Magazine*, and *Bad to the Bone*.

In 2023, she won the Small File Photo Festival, organized by The Photographers' Gallery in London.

Work

edit

Sandler's projects often combine photography with conceptual narratives, drawing on philosophy, literature, and science. Her works include:

The World of Hedonia (2021)

edit

A series exploring pleasure and the affective economies of late capitalism.

The World of Hedonia

My Nonhuman Friends (2021)

edit

A reflection on human–feline relationships through archival images, feline perspectives, and personal recollections.

My Nonhuman Friends

A History of Teeth (2023)

edit

An investigation of teeth as emotional and material archives, linking human experience to bacterial life and machine vision.

A History of Teeth

Mycophilia (2022)

edit

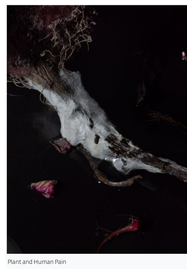
Depicting fungi as hospitable, creative beings, inverting cultural associations with decay and death.

Mycophilia

Plant and Human Pain (2022)

edit

A visual exploration of the parallels between plant and human suffering.



Plant and Human Pain

The Black Sun (2022)

edit

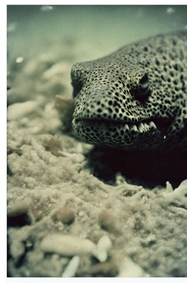
A digital exploration of autocratic states through artifacts captured on Google Street View.

The Black Sun

The Ancient Depths (2024)

edit

A collaboration with AI imagining extinct marine species and engaging with contemporary ecological anxieties.



The Ancient Depths

Reception

edit

Sandler's work has been the subject of interviews and critical essays in international outlets. *Konbini* has described her as exploring the "pleasure and pain, life and death" inherent in bodily metaphors. *Dazed* highlighted her use of photography to examine feline perspectives and interspecies intimacy. *Público* presented her series The Black Sun as a meditation on authoritarian regimes.

Her practice has also been studied in academic research. In *The Image at the End of the World* (2025), Marloes de Valk discusses Sandler's work in the context of artistic communities rethinking technology in the Anthropocene.

External links

edit

Official website
Internet Archive
OSF
Zenodo
Conifer archive
Flickr